

RAJASTHAN ORIGIN

Govind Gatta Curry

Stuffed Gram Flour Dumplings
in a Rich Festive Gravy

AUTHENTIC RECIPE · STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE · PRINTABLE DIGITAL COOKBOOK

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ABOUT THIS BOOK

Govind Gatta Curry

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DISCLAIMER

Nutrition values are estimates. Cooking times vary with equipment and ingredients. Readers with allergies or dietary restrictions should check every ingredient label before cooking.

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THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

The Celebration Version of an Everyday Classic

If gatte ki sabzi represents Rajasthani resourcefulness at its most practical, govind gatta curry represents what happens when that same core technique is elevated for a special occasion. Building on the basic besan dumpling method, govind gatte are stuffed — often with a mixture of paneer, dried fruits, or a spiced filling — before being simmered in a considerably richer, creamier gravy than their everyday counterpart.

The name "Govind" is generally understood to reference Govind, one of the names for Lord Krishna, suggesting the dish's association with temple offerings and festive, auspicious occasions rather than routine home cooking — though as with many dish-name etymologies, the exact history isn't precisely documented, and some food writers note it may also simply reflect a chef or family name lost to wider record.

Whatever its exact naming origin, govind gatta curry has become a fixture at Rajasthani weddings and celebrations, valued as the dressier, more indulgent cousin to everyday gatte ki sabzi — proof that even a dish born from desert necessity can be reimagined into something suitable for a proper feast.

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THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

The Celebration Version of an Everyday Classic, continued

CULTURAL NOTES & OCCASIONS

An elevated, festive version of the everyday gatte ki sabzi, featuring stuffed dumplings in a richer gravy. The name likely references Govind, a name for Lord Krishna, suggesting associations with temple offerings and auspicious occasions, though the exact etymology isn't precisely documented. A fixture at Rajasthani weddings and celebrations, standing as the more indulgent counterpart to its everyday relative. Demonstrates how a resourceful, practical dish can be reimagined for special occasions without losing its core technique.

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AT A GLANCE

Equipment & preparation

35m	30m	4	Hard
ACTIVE PREP	COOK TIME	SERVINGS	DIFFICULTY

Recommended equipment

- Mixing bowls
- Large pot, for boiling the gatte
- Small blender, for the cashew paste
- Kadai or wide pan, for the gravy
- Sharp knife

STORAGE & MAKE-AHEAD

Govind gatta curry keeps refrigerated for up to 2 days, best enjoyed relatively fresh given the rich, cream-finished gravy. It doesn't freeze particularly well, as the texture of the stuffing and cream-based sauce can suffer on thawing.

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WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients

For the gatte dough

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Besan (gram flour)	1½ cups	180 g	1½ katori
Ajwain (carom seeds)	½ tsp	1.5 g	½ chammach
Turmeric powder	¼ tsp	1 g	¼ chammach
Yogurt	2 tbsp	30 g	2 chammach
Oil	2 tbsp	30 ml	2 chammach
Salt	½ tsp	3 g	to taste
Water, as needed	3–4 tbsp	45–60 ml	3–4 chammach

For the stuffing

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Paneer, crumbled	½ cup	100 g	½ katori
Cashews, chopped	2 tbsp	20 g	2 tbsp
Raisins, chopped	1 tbsp	10 g	1 tbsp
Green chili, minced	1	1	1
Salt	pinch	pinch	chutki bhar

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WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients, continued

For the rich gravy

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Ghee	3 tbsp	45 g	3 chammach
Cumin seeds	1 tsp	4 g	1 chammach
Onion, finely chopped	1 medium	100 g	1 medium
Cashews, for the gravy paste	3 tbsp	35 g	3 chammach
Ginger-garlic paste	1 tbsp	15 g	1 chammach
Tomato puree	1 cup	240 ml	1 katori
Plain yogurt, whisked	½ cup	120 g	½ katori
Kashmiri red chili powder	1 tsp	3 g	1 chammach
Garam masala	½ tsp	1.5 g	½ chammach
Cream	3 tbsp	45 ml	3 chammach
Salt	1 tsp	6 g	to taste

SUBSTITUTIONS & SOURCING

This dish requires slightly more effort to source than everyday gatte ki sabzi, given the paneer stuffing and cashew-based gravy, but all ingredients are widely available at any Indian grocer. Firm tofu can substitute for paneer in the stuffing if needed, though the flavor will differ somewhat from the traditional version.

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STEP BY STEP · PART ONE

Making the Stuffed Gatte

01 MAKE THE DOUGH

Combine besan, ajwain, turmeric, yogurt, oil, and salt. Gradually add water, kneading to a firm dough.

02 PREPARE THE STUFFING

Mix the crumbled paneer, chopped cashews, raisins, green chili, and a pinch of salt into a cohesive filling.

03 STUFF AND SHAPE

Divide the dough into small portions, flatten each into a disc, place a small spoonful of stuffing in the center, and seal into a smooth ball, rolling gently into a short log shape.

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Making the Stuffed Gatte, continued



Chef tip. seal the edges thoroughly to prevent the stuffing from leaking out during boiling — pinch firmly and roll smooth.

04 BOIL UNTIL FIRM

Boil the stuffed gatte in gently simmering water for 12–15 minutes, until firm and cooked through. Drain and let cool slightly before slicing into rounds.

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STEP BY STEP · PART ONE

Making the Stuffed Gatte, continued

COOKING CHECKPOINT

The stuffed gatte should feel firm to the touch with no leaking filling — a small test piece cut open should show the stuffing intact at the center.

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STEP BY STEP · PART TWO

The Rich Gravy

05 MAKE THE CASHEW PASTE

Soak the cashews in warm water for 15 minutes, then blend to a smooth paste with a little water.

06 BUILD THE GRAVY BASE

Heat ghee in a kadai, add cumin seeds, then the chopped onion, cooking until golden. Add ginger-garlic paste, cooking until fragrant, then the tomato puree and cashew paste, simmering for 10 minutes.



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STEP BY STEP · PART TWO

The Rich Gravy, continued

07 ADD YOGURT AND SPICES

Reduce heat to low and stir in the whisked yogurt, Kashmiri chili powder, and garam masala, stirring constantly for the first minute to prevent splitting.

08 ADD THE GATTE AND CREAM

Gently add the sliced stuffed gatte, along with salt, and simmer for 5 minutes to let them absorb the gravy's flavor. Stir in the cream just before serving.

Texture indicator. the finished gravy should be thick, rich, and glossy, generously coating the stuffed gatte pieces.

MISTAKE TO AVOID

Rushing the sealing step when stuffing the gatte often results in filling leaking out during boiling. Take the time to pinch and seal each piece thoroughly before cooking.

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SERVING & PAIRING

How to serve



Traditional Style

- Served at weddings and festive Rajasthani gatherings, alongside naan or roti.
- A more indulgent alternative to everyday gatte ki sabzi for special occasions.

Restaurant Presentation

- Served in a bowl with a rich, glossy gravy, garnished with a swirl of cream and fresh coriander.

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SERVING & PAIRING

How to serve, continued

Family Style

- A celebratory centerpiece dish for family gatherings and festival meals.

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RESTAURANT-GRADE TRICKS

Chef secrets

Getting the Stuffing Right

- Thoroughly sealing each stuffed gatte prevents filling from escaping during the boiling stage.
- A smooth cashew paste is essential for the gravy's signature rich, velvety texture.

Make-Ahead & Meal Prep

- Stuffed gatte can be boiled and sliced a day ahead, refrigerated, and added to fresh gravy when ready to serve.
- The cashew paste can also be made ahead, speeding up final cooking for a gathering.

RESTAURANT TRICK

Some Rajasthani caterers add a pinch of kasuri methi to the gravy for extra aroma, a technique borrowed from North Indian restaurant-style curries that pairs well with this dish's richness.

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BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ

APPROXIMATE NUTRITION, PER SERVING

320 kcal	12 g	24 g	20 g	4 g
CALORIES	PROTEIN	CARBOHYDRATES	FAT	FIBER

Estimates only; actual values vary with ghee and portion size.

ALLERGEN GUIDE

Contains, based on the ingredient list: Dairy, Tree nuts. Check packaged spices and asafoetida, which may contain wheat, and verify against your own ingredients.

REGIONAL VARIATIONS

Paneer-Stuffed Govind Gatta	the classic version featured here.
Dry Fruit Govind Gatta	a stuffing emphasizing dried fruits and nuts over paneer, for a sweeter note.
Simplified Govind Gatta	a shortcut version using plain gatte in the rich gravy, without the stuffing step.

Why did my stuffing leak out during boiling?

Almost always insufficient sealing. Pinch the edges firmly and roll smooth before boiling.

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BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ, continued

Can I make this less rich?

Yes — reduce the cashew paste and cream slightly for a lighter, though still indulgent, version.

What's the difference between this and regular gatte ki sabzi?

Govind gatta curry features stuffed dumplings in a richer, cashew-and-cream-based gravy, while regular gatte ki sabzi uses plain dumplings in a simpler, tangier yogurt gravy.

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REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary



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REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary, continued

GLOSSARY

Govind	a name for Lord Krishna, likely referenced in this dish's name given its festive associations.
Gatte	gram flour dumplings, the base technique shared with gatte ki sabzi.
Kasuri Methi	dried fenugreek leaves, sometimes added to the gravy for aroma.
Malai	Hindi for cream, used to finish this dish's rich gravy.

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PRINTABLE RECIPE CARD

Govind Gatta Curry

35m	30m
ACTIVE PREP	COOK TIME
4	Hard
SERVINGS	DIFFICULTY

GATTE DOUGH

Besan	180 g
Ajwain	1.5 g
Turmeric powder	1 g
Yogurt	30 g
Oil	30 ml
Salt	3 g
Water	45–60 ml

STUFFING

Paneer	100 g
Cashews	20 g
Raisins	10 g
Green chili	1
Salt	pinch

RICH GRAVY

Ghee	45 g
Cumin seeds	4 g
Onion	100 g
Cashews	35 g
Ginger-garlic paste	15 g
Tomato puree	240 ml
Plain yogurt	120 g
Kashmiri red chili powder	3 g
Garam masala	1.5 g
Cream	45 ml
Salt	6 g

METHOD

01 **Make the dough.** Combine besan, ajwain, turmeric, yogurt, oil, and salt.

02 **Prepare the stuffing.** Mix the crumbled paneer, chopped cashews, raisins, green chili, and a pinch of salt into a cohesive filling.

03 **Stuff and shape.** Divide the dough into small portions, flatten each into a disc, place a small spoonful of stuffing in the center, and seal into a smooth ball, rolling gently into a short log shape.

04 **Boil until firm.** Boil the stuffed gatte in gently simmering water for 12–15 minutes, until firm and cooked through.

05 **Make the cashew paste.** Soak the cashews in warm water for 15 minutes, then blend to a smooth paste with a little water.

06 **Build the gravy base.** Heat ghee in a kadai, add cumin seeds, then the chopped onion, cooking until golden.

07 **Add yogurt and spices.** Reduce heat to low and stir in the whisked yogurt, Kashmiri chili powder, and garam masala, stirring constantly for the first minute to prevent splitting.

08 **Add the gatte and cream.** Gently add the sliced stuffed gatte, along with salt, and simmer for 5 minutes to let them absorb the gravy's flavor.

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BEFORE YOU SHOP

Shopping list

☐ Besan	180 g	☐ Ajwain	1.5 g
☐ Turmeric powder	1 g	☐ Yogurt	30 g
☐ Oil	30 ml	☐ Salt	see recipe
☐ Paneer	100 g	☐ Cashews	see recipe
☐ Raisins	10 g	☐ Green chili	1
☐ Ghee	45 g	☐ Cumin seeds	4 g
☐ Onion	100 g	☐ Ginger-garlic paste	15 g
☐ Tomato puree	240 ml	☐ Plain yogurt	120 g
☐ Kashmiri red chili powder	3 g	☐ Garam masala	1.5 g
☐ Cream	45 ml		

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